



OAS | CICAD

SATA e-Newsletter Vol.30

July, 2026

SATA

The Inter-American Observatory on Drugs (OID), of the Inter-American Drug Abuse Control Commission (CICAD), of the Organization of American States (OAS) manages and coordinates the Early Warning System of the Americas (SATA) within the framework CICAD's mandates.

The SATA operates as a clearinghouse and dissemination platform for information on emerging drug threats, fueled by alerts issued by national early warning systems (EWS). It also fosters international and horizontal cooperation in drug monitoring and response efforts.

For more information on new and emerging drugs in the Americas, visit: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/security/early-warnings-system>

INTER-AMERICAN DRUG ABUSE CONTROL COMMISSION (CICAD)

INTER-AMERICAN OBSERVATORY ON DRUGS (OID)

<https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs>

SATA

Early Warning System of the Americas

Summary of Emerging Drug Alerts and Information in June 2026

1. **DIVERSION OF HOSPITAL-USE MEDICATIONS FOR NON-MEDICAL USE**
2. **CO-OCCURRENCE OF SUBSTANCES**
3. **EMERGING DRUGS AND TRENDS IN THE U.S.**
4. **RAPID STREET REPORTING DATA**
5. **MMDPPA**
6. **MEDETOMIDINE**
7. **MDPV**
8. **DIMETHOCAINE**
9. **FENTANYL**
10. **KETAMINE**

KEY FINDINGS

Information from the National EWS In the Region

Argentina's Early Warning System highlighted the risk of diversion of substances intended for hospital, medical, and veterinary use. Argentina's Superintendence of Scientific Police of the Autonomous City of Buenos Aires reported ampoules containing fentanyl, propofol, midazolam, and diazepam, confirming a pattern of diversion first identified in late 2023. Toxicology laboratories also reported increase in criminal activity involving the diversion of legally marketed medications, including intravenous anesthetics, opioids, benzodiazepines, and barbiturates.

Brazil's Early Warning System (EWS) issued an alert on two seizures of alpha-methyl-1,3-benzodioxole-5-propanimide, also known as alpha-methyl-3,4-methylenedioxyphenylpropionamide (MMDPPA), a precursor used in the synthesis of tenamfetamine (MDA), an amphetamine-type stimulant. Authorities had previously identified MMDPPA as a residual component in tablets sold as "ecstasy", underscoring the risks of products of unknown composition and drug mixtures, and possible local production. The chemical name and its role as an MDA precursor are consistent with international and Brazilian nomenclature.

Brazil's EWS also reported the seizure of 1,064 grams of 3-(diethylamino)-2,2-dimethylpropyl 4-aminobenzoate, in powder or crystalline form. Dimethocaine, a synthetic local anesthetic and cocaine analogue, was identified in an international courier shipment destined for São Paulo, illustrating the use of international postal and courier channels to distribute New Psychoactive Substances (NPS) and other emerging synthetic drugs.

Laboratory analysis in Brazil also confirmed the presence of fentanyl in samples of powdered cocaine seized in August 2024. Fentanyl was detected mixed with cocaine in these samples; however, the alert did not report the quantity or concentration of fentanyl present. The materials submitted for laboratory analysis included 548 small containers holding a combined 902.6 grams of powder and a separate package containing 1,636.2 grams, and 197 ampoules of fentanyl.

The Canadian Centre on Substance Use and Addiction (CCSA) highlighted the increase in medetomidine detection in Ontario, Saskatchewan, Alberta, and British Columbia between January and March 2026. Drug checking results showed that as the co-detection of medetomidine with opioids increased, the xylazine co-detection decreased in British Columbia, Alberta, and Ontario. The introduction of medetomidine test strips in some Canadian regions is also helping people who use drugs identify and avoid substances containing medetomidine.

The U.S. Early Warning System (NDEWS) reported trends in over 10 states involving the combined use or co-occurrence of fentanyl or other opioids with methamphetamine and/or cocaine. These findings underscore the difficulty of determining whether such combinations reflect intentional co-use or unintentional exposure to multiple substances. NDEWS also highlighted broader changes in the U.S. drug landscape and associated health risks, including emerging concerns related to gabapentin, psilocybin, fentanyl, adulterants, and polysubstance use.

Rapid Street Reporting findings from Atlanta, Dallas, and Miami were also highlighted, based on survey responses from over 590 people. Across the three cities, the substances most commonly reported as having been used in the previous 12 months were alcohol and cannabis for recreational purposes, followed by delta-8 THC and psilocybin. Miami recorded the highest prevalence of polysubstance use, which also included powder cocaine, ecstasy/MDMA/Molly, and ketamine.

Patterns of 3,4-methylenedioxypyrovalerone (MDPV) use were also reported in the U.S. MDPV is associated with intense stimulant effects and a strong urge to redose, which may contribute to severe neurological and behavioral effects. Authorities have also expressed concern about its availability through online illicit markets and other illegal distribution chains.

Trinidad and Tobago's EWS reported an increase in the non-medical use of ketamine by adolescents in nightlife settings. Authorities seized 62.4 grams of ketamine between 2020 and 2023, followed by 90 grams in 2024. By December 2025, the quantity seized had risen to more than 3,000 grams. Given ketamine's rapid anesthetic effects and its potential to cause memory impairment or amnesia, authorities have warned of the significant health and personal risks associated with its misuse.

Alerts Received and Information Collected

1. Argentina (June 30, 2026) - Diversion of hospital-use medications for non-medical use

Argentina's Early Warning System (EWS) has identified a growing trend in the diversion of medicines intended for hospital and veterinary use for illicit purpose since late 2023. In April 2026, authorities reported the seizure of ampoules containing fentanyl, propofol, midazolam, and diazepam. Between January 2024 and May 2026, the EWS issued six public alerts concerning the diversion of controlled medicines, hospital-use substances, and veterinary products. Substances identified through these alerts included THC, methylphenidate, nordiazepam, fentanyl, pregabalin, carisoprodol, xylazine, and medetomidine.

Data from Argentina's National Drug Observatory indicate that tranquilizers remain the most frequently used psychotropic substances *without a medical prescription*. Lifetime prevalence was 10.7% among university students in 2023, and 14.1% among the general population aged 16–75 in 2022. Among secondary school students in 2025, 5.9% reported having used tranquilizers at least once in their lifetime without a prescription.

Pharmacies and social networks, including family and friends, were identified as the main sources of access. By contrast, ketamine use remained relatively low across all surveyed populations.

Authorities emphasized the serious health risks associated with the non-medical use of pharmaceutical substances, particularly when they are consumed through unsafe routes of administration that increase the risk of infectious diseases and other adverse health outcomes.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/ourstructure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/139>

Argentina's Early Warning System: <https://www.argentina.gob.ar/sat/alertas>

2. United States (June 26, 2026) – Co-occurrence of substances

The National Drug Early Warning System (NDEWS) Weekly Briefing highlighted the growing co-use and co-occurrence of fentanyl and other opioids with methamphetamine and cocaine across multiple U.S. jurisdictions. Cities including Atlanta, Denver, New York City, Philadelphia, San Diego, San Francisco, St. Louis, and Chicago, as well as the states of Florida, Kentucky, Nebraska, and Ohio, reported increasing polysubstance use, drug adulteration, and contamination of the illicit drug supply.

Key findings included the detection of fentanyl in stimulant and other non-opioid samples, the increasing presence of veterinary sedatives such as xylazine and medetomidine, and sporadic detections of emerging substances and synthetic adulterants. Several jurisdictions reported that most fatal overdoses involved multiple substances, with fentanyl frequently detected alongside cocaine, methamphetamine, alcohol, or novel benzodiazepines. Wastewater surveillance, forensic laboratory analyses, and syringe residue testing also identified substances such as carfentanil, parafluorofentanyl, and nitazenes. New York City and Philadelphia also documented the widespread presence of xylazine and medetomidine in samples sold as opioids. Reports from San Francisco indicated that some fatal fentanyl overdoses involved intermittent, first-time, or unintentional exposure, while data from San Diego showed that fentanyl and related compounds were sometimes detected in samples sold as non-opioids. Overall, the findings underscore the increasing complexity, unpredictability, and toxicity of the illicit drug market in the United States.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/149>

NDEWS: <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-290/>

3. United States (June 17, 2026) – Emerging drugs and trends in the U.S.

The NDEWS Weekly Report highlighted research presented at the Fifth Annual NDEWS Summit, held in conjunction with the 2026 College on Problems of Drug Dependence (CPDD). NDEWS Sentinel Site Directors, scientific advisors, leaders, and other community members convened to discuss emerging substances and evolving drug trends in the U.S.

Key topics included the nonmedical use of gabapentin, changes in reported psilocybin use, methods for identifying fatal overdoses involving unintentional fentanyl or non-regular fentanyl use, emerging adulterants in the illicit drug supply, and the challenges and best practices of studying polysubstance use. The presentations illustrated the rapidly changing U.S. drug landscape and the resulting implications for overdose surveillance, substance-use research, treatment, and public health responses.

Sources

SATA, <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/149>

NDEWS: <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-289-this-weeks-focus-5th-annual-ndews-summit-at-the-2026-college-on-problems-of-drug-dependence-cpdd/>

4. United States (June 12, 2026) – Rapid Street Reporting Data

The NDEWS Weekly Report Briefing presented findings from its Rapid Street Reporting (RSR) study, including findings from the cities of Atlanta, Dallas, and Miami. Across the three cities, a total of 598 individuals were surveyed in March 2026.

In Atlanta, Georgia, the RSR team surveyed 270 individuals between March 6 and 8, 2026. The most commonly reported substance used in the previous 12 months was alcohol (64.1%), followed by marijuana for recreational use (50.7%). Other commonly reported substances included delta-8 THC (16%), psilocybin (10.4%), methamphetamine (8.9%), marijuana for medical use (8.9%), and delta-10 THC (7.8%).

In Dallas, Texas, experts surveyed 225 individuals from March 20 to 22, 2026. As in Atlanta, alcohol was the most commonly reported substance (63.1%), followed by marijuana for recreational use (35.6%). Other commonly reported substances include delta-8 THC (13.3%), psilocybin (12.0%), delta-10 THC (8.4%), and marijuana for medical use (7.6%).

In Miami, Florida, the RSR team surveyed 103 individuals between March 27 and 29, 2026. Miami recorded the highest reported prevalence of alcohol use (83.5%) and recreational marijuana use (56.3%) among the three cities. Participants also reported comparatively high levels of psilocybin use (30.1%), ecstasy/MDMA/Molly use (16.5%), powder cocaine use (15.5%), marijuana for medical use (15.5%), and ketamine (11.7%). Data collection in Miami coincided with the Ultra Music Festival, an important contextual factor when interpreting the findings.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/149>

NDEWS: <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-288-this-weeks-focus/>

5. Brazil (June 09, 2026) – MMDPPA Alert

Brazil's Early Warning System (SAR, by its Portuguese acronym) issued an alert following two seizures in Araucaria and Guaratuba, in the Paraná region. The seizures occurred in May 2026 and involved a combined 48.98 grams of crystalline material and tablets. Laboratory analysis identified MMDPPA (alpha-methyl-3,4-methylenedioxyphenylpropionamide) as the principal component.

MMDPPA is a precursor used in the manufacture of MDA, an amphetamine-type stimulant. The substance had previously been detected as a residual precursor in tablets sold as "ecstasy," highlighting the risks associated with products of unknown composition and the presence of impurities or residual substances from illicit manufacturing processes. Its detection in seized products has rarely been documented in Brazilian scientific literature.

The detection of compounds rarely encountered in Brazil may signal changes in the synthetic-drug market, including the use of alternative production methods, the operation of clandestine laboratories, and possible domestic manufacture. The findings reinforce the value of forensic monitoring in identifying emerging substances and changes in illicit production practices.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/141>

SAR Brazil: <https://www.gov.br/mj/pt-br/assuntos/sua-protecao/politicas-sobre-drogas/obid/alertas-rapidos>

6. Canada (June 08, 2026) – Growing presence of medetomidine in the unregulated drug supply

A recent publication by the Canadian Centre on Substance Use and Addiction, developed in consultation with the Canadian Community Epidemiology Network on Drug Use (CCENDU), highlighted the growing presence of medetomidine a veterinary tranquilizer, in the unregulated drug supply. Detections have continued to increase, with significant associated harms reported in many regions of Canada. Medetomidine is rarely detected on its own and is most commonly found with opioids, particularly fentanyl and its analogs. Samples may also contain one or more benzodiazepines, xylazine, other sedatives, or combinations of these substances, creating complex and unpredictable toxicity profiles.

Authorities warned that medetomidine can cause severe and prolonged sedation, a slow heart rate, low blood pressure, delirium or hallucinations, dizziness, and fluctuating levels of consciousness. These risks are compounded by the uncertain composition and concentration of the substances obtained from the unregulated market.

Health Canada's Drug Analysis Service data for January to March 2026, showed that Ontario accounted for the highest proportion of seized samples, followed by Saskatchewan, Alberta, and British Columbia. Among samples containing medetomidine, fentanyl analogs were the substances most frequently co-detected, underscoring the increasingly unpredictable composition of the unregulated opioid supply.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/ga/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/142>

CCSA: https://www.ccsa.ca/sites/default/files/2026-06/CCENDU-Issue-8-en_1.pdf

7. United States (June 05, 2026) – MDPV Alert: substance known as “monkey dust”

The NDEWS Weekly Report Briefing highlighted findings on MDPV (3,4-methylenedioxypyrovalerone), commonly referred to as “monkey dust.” The briefing identified renewed online interest in and discussion of MDPV, a synthetic cathinone belonging to the pyrovalerone class. MDPV acts as a dopamine and norepinephrine reuptake inhibitor and is typically encountered in crystalline powder or tablet form. Online discussion also described its availability through research chemical markets and illicit supply chains.

Reported adverse effects included cardiovascular strain, paranoia, acute psychosis, and unpredictable behavior. The combined effects of sustained stimulation and sleep deprivation may contribute to loss of behavioral control and heightened neurological vulnerability. Online discussants described an intense stimulant effect and a strong compulsion to redose during prolonged periods of use, sometimes comparing its effects

with those of cocaine or methamphetamine. Discussions also addressed the emergence of new structural analogs designed to circumvent existing controls.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/149>

NDEWS: <https://ndews.org/newsletter/ndews-weekly-briefing-issue-287-this-weeks-focus/>

8. Brazil (June 03, 2026) – Dimethocaine Alert

Brazil's EWS reported the identification of dimethocaine in an international courier shipment to São Paulo. The Federal Police seized 1,064 grams of 3-(diethylamino)-2,2-dimethylpropyl 4-aminobenzoate, presented in powdered and crystalline form. Dimethocaine is a synthetic local anesthetic with cocaine-like stimulant effects and has been marketed or used as a substitute for, or adulterant in, cocaine. Brazil's SAR classified the substance as a new psychoactive substance (NPS).

Although dimethocaine was not subject to special control under SVS/MS Ordinance No. 344/1998 in Brazil at the time of the alert, authorities warned that it may pose public health risks because of its distinct pharmacological profile and the limited scientific information available on its use and effects. The alert emphasized the importance of monitoring emerging synthetic-drug trends, incorporating relevant NPS data into forensic spectral libraries, and strengthening oversight of international postal and courier channels used to distribute chemical precursors.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/141>

SAR Brazil: <https://www.gov.br/mj/pt-br/assuntos/sua-protacao/politicas-sobre-drogas/obid/alertas-rapidos>

9. Brazil (June 03, 2026) - Fentanyl Alert

The Forensic Chemistry Laboratory of the Espírito Santo Scientific Police confirmed the detection of fentanyl in samples of powdered cocaine seized in August 2024. During the operation, authorities also seized 197 ampoules of fentanyl. The materials submitted for laboratory analysis included 548 small containers holding a combined 902.6 grams of powder and a separate package containing 1,636.2 grams. Fentanyl was detected mixed with cocaine in these samples; however, the alert did not report the quantity or concentration of fentanyl present.

Authorities emphasized that this remains an isolated occurrence, with no evidence to date of widespread circulation of fentanyl-contaminated cocaine in Brazil. Nevertheless, the

finding raises serious concerns because fentanyl is a highly potent synthetic opioid, and exposure to even small quantities can cause severe poisoning, respiratory depression, loss of consciousness, and a potentially fatal overdose.

Signs of opioid poisoning may include extreme drowsiness; reduced or complete loss of consciousness; slow, shallow, or absent breathing; abnormal respiratory sounds such as snoring, choking, or gurgling; constricted pupils; cold skin; and bluish or grayish discoloration of the lips or extremities.

The alert noted that conventional laboratory screening methods may fail to detect fentanyl in cocaine samples, particularly when it is present at low concentrations. Forensic laboratories were therefore advised to consider complementary, more sensitive analytical techniques when synthetic opioids are suspected. The alert also emphasized the importance of appropriate biosafety precautions when handling suspected samples.

Sources

SATA: <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/141>

SAR Brazil: <https://www.gov.br/mj/pt-br/assuntos/sua-protecao/politicas-sobre-drogas/obid/alertas-rapidos>

10. Trinidad and Tobago (December 19, 2025– received in June 2026) – Ketamine Alert

Trinidad and Tobago’s Early Warning System for New Psychoactive Substances reported the growing public health concerns associated with the non-medical use of ketamine, particularly among adolescents and youth in nightlife settings. Ketamine is a dissociative anesthetic used in human and veterinary medicine and may also be administered in certain clinical settings for pain management and depressive disorders. According to the alert, ketamine seizures increased from 62.4 grams between 2020 and 2023 to approximately 90 grams in 2024 and more than 3,000 grams by December 2025.

Ketamine is sometimes referred to as a “party drug” because of its dissociative effects, and is often combined with stimulants such as MDMA, methamphetamine, and cocaine, as well as with alcohol and other central nervous system depressants. These combinations can produce severe and unpredictable health effects and may be fatal. Authorities also reported the local detection of a drug mixture containing ketamine and MDMA and marketed as “pink cocaine.” Products sold under this name have no standardized composition and may contain varying combinations of ketamine, MDMA, methamphetamine, cocaine, opioids, or new psychoactive substances.

The alert further warned that ketamine may be used to facilitate sexual assault because its rapid sedative effects can cause incapacitation, confusion, and memory impairment. Individuals were advised not to leave drinks unattended or accept open drinks from people they do not trust, and to seek immediate assistance if they suddenly experience unusual

drowsiness, disorientation, impaired coordination, or memory loss. Reliance on an unusual smell or taste is not an effective precaution, because ketamine may not be readily detectable in a beverage.

Source: SATA, <https://www.oas.org/ext/en/main/oas/our-structure/gs/sms/cicad/interamerican-observatory-drugs/sata-country-documents/country/id/144>

